

cousins OpenOffice.org and NeoOffice, mainly its file format design which is the international ISO/IEC standard open document format. These similarities mean that users would be unable to distinguish the operational features of the suite from that of its cousins and enjoy the same level of adaptability and usability.



Libre Office – The new wave

Due to the rise in popularity of proprietary office suite formats such as Microsoft Office, developers have made changes to open source software to increase compatibility of files across platforms. Even as time progresses, glitches in formatting and layout are still being worked on and the property of the file format being interchangeable is imminent. The application is available in over 110 languages and is functional across all major operating systems including Microsoft Windows, Apple's Mac OS X (Snow Leopard and beyond) and Linux.

History and development

The history of LibreOffice begins within the world of Apache's OpenOffice.org organisation. Despite its open source systems and free-to-use model, the OpenOffice.org systems are operated and governed by a corporate entity, which is made up of major companies such as IBM and Sun. This form of governance and oversight was considered by many within the developers community of OpenOffice.org as being too over-reaching and controlling. The problem was addressed when The Document Foundation was created.

The Document Foundation was created towards the end of 2010 and became a legal entity in 2012 as a not for profit organisation solely focused on promoting open source document management applications. The members within the OpenOffice.org who were at odds with the corporate heads of their organisation forked off and created a new variation of the open source productivity suite and named it LibreOffice in Germany. This was mainly since all the developers who were working on the OpenOffice.org system were required to assign their copyright to the corporate entity (Oracle, at